

The Washington Post

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 Mostly cloudy 33/27 • Tomorrow: Cloudy, breezy 38/25 B6 *Democracy Dies in Darkness* FRIDAY, JANUARY 10, 2025 • \$4

Protests roil plan to inaugurate Maduro

Venezuela's 'Iron Lady' opposition leader out of hiding, is briefly detained

BY SAMANTHA SCHMIDT

María Corina Machado, the driving force of Venezuela's opposition movement, was briefly detained Thursday as she left a rally in Caracas, the opposition campaign said, a day before President Nicolás Maduro plans to take office for a third term.

Machado was "intercepted and knocked off the motorcycle she was riding," amid gunfire, the campaign said in a statement on X. "She was taken away by force. During the period of her kidnapping she was forced to record several videos." She was later released.

"The fact that María Corina is free does not minimize what happened," said Edmundo González, the exiled opposition leader recognized by the United States and several other countries as Venezuela's president-elect, adding "she was kidnapped in conditions of violence."

Venezuela's interior minister, Diosdado Cabello, in a televised interview accused Machado of "lying" about the detention.

"That was their plan, to tell the world 'I was captured' to see what it would generate," Cabello said.

While the circumstances of her brief detention and release remained unclear, Thursday's events left Venezuelans in a moment of heightened tension and SEE VENEZUELA ON A9

Missing: A wave of detentions in Venezuela includes Americans. **A8**

Justices won't delay Trump hush money sentencing

BY ANN E. MARIMOW AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

A closely divided Supreme Court refused to delay Donald Trump's sentencing in his hush money case, clearing the way for the president-elect to face judgment in a New York courtroom on Friday and to be formally classified as a felon before he returns to the White House.

Trump turned to the high court in a last-ditch effort to stop the hearing, citing the conservative majority's explosive opinion in July that granted him and other former presidents immunity from criminal prosecution for their official acts.

But five of the nine justices said Trump's immunity concerns about evidence presented at his trial can be addressed "in the ordinary course on appeal."

Trump is set to be sentenced Friday, after a jury convicted him of 34 counts of falsifying business records related to a hush money payment made to an adult-film actress during the 2016 election. New York Supreme Court Justice Juan SEE TRUMP ON A4

Smith report: Court allows public release of Trump election probe. **A4**

A final farewell to the 39th president

During a state funeral, Jimmy Carter is remembered as a man with 'a tough mind and a tender heart'



Jimmy Carter's casket is carried away, past mourners including all of the former living presidents, during his funeral at Washington National Cathedral on Thursday. President Joe Biden was among those who eulogized Carter, who served from 1977 to 1981.

Gerald Ford: Eulogy delivered by his son honors an "old friend." **AA3**

5 presidents: Warmth, frostiness are seen, Robin Givhan writes. **AA3**

Shift on Hill: Praise for Carter was once rare, Paul Kane writes. **AA5**

Nobel vindication: 2002 prize affirmed '78 Israel-Egypt pact. **AA6**

This article is by Lauren Lumpkin, Michelle Boorstein, Roxanne Roberts, Holly Bailey and Paul Duggan

Jimmy Carter, the centenarian former president who brought hope to people around the world through decades of post-White-House humanitarian work, was eulogized by President Joe Biden and others Thursday in the capital's grandest church, where his long-ago United Nations ambassador Andrew Young extolled Carter's "ability to achieve greatness by the diversity of his personality and upbringing."

Addressing several thousand mourners at Carter's state funeral at Washington National Cathedral, the 92-year-old Young, a minister in the United Church of Christ, recalled his and his friend's deeply contrasting Georgia heritages — the Jim Crow-era legacies of Black oppression and White privilege — and how the 39th president managed to bridge a cultural divide that spans American history.

"It was something of a miracle," Young said. "And I don't mean this with any disrespect: It's still hard for me to understand how you could get to be president from Plains, Georgia," which drew ripples of laughter in the packed pews.

The Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. "used to say greatness is characterized by antithesis strongly marked," Young added, barely looking at his rolled-up notes. "You've got to have a tough mind and a tender heart. And that was Jimmy Carter."

"He grew up in the tremendous diversity of the South," Young said, "and he embraced both sides."

Carter, the longest-living former president, who died Dec. 29 at 100, often eschewed the pomp of high office as haughty and unbecoming. He was a peanut farmer and Southern governor who arrived in Washington as a self-styled avatar of the ordinary citizen, elected in 1976 to restore trust in government after the bitter years of Vietnam and Watergate. Yet Thursday's farewell, hewing to national tradition, was replete with the exalted trappings of a presidential send-off.

There were orchestral preludes — "My Shepherd Will Supply My Need," "Thou Gracious God, Whose Mercy Lends" — before SEE CARTER ON AA2

Democrats playing catch-up in influencer race

BY DYLAN WELLS

Less than a month before the election, Donald Trump appeared on the comedy podcast "Flagrant," where he discussed topics both informal — making his son clean up after a party at Trump Tower — and more serious: the assassination attempt against him in Pennsylvania.

Seated on a gray couch, he mused about his mother, bragged about his children and discussed

Politicos say party was outmatched by Trump's more aggressive strategy

abortion policy for nearly an hour and a half. Noting how he was taking time away from more traditional campaigning to speak on the show, Trump declared, "It's a whole new different way of

getting the word out."

The interview was one of many lengthy sit-downs during the closing months of the campaign that Trump granted with content creators — a growing group of podcasters, TikTokers, vloggers and others who feed a \$250 billion industry. Trump discussed his favorite musicians and did his signature dance with streamer Adin Ross, brought pranksters the Nelk Boys aboard Trump Force One, and delayed a swing-

state rally to chat with Joe Rogan for nearly three hours.

"It's entertainment, but it's also very serious," Trump said of "Flagrant." "If it was just funny stuff, you wouldn't have the success you've got, to be honest with you. It's nice to intersperse it."

While both Democrats and Republicans stepped up their work with creators in the most recent cycle, hoping to reach voters who don't follow more SEE INFLUENCERS ON A16

A rising toll of death, destruction expected in Calif. wildfires

After respite, fierce winds back in the forecast

BY JOSHUA PARTLOW, N. KIRKPATRICK AND BRADY DENNIS

ALTADENA, CALIF. — On the third day, the fires kept burning.

They continued to destroy homes and businesses, trigger evacuations and stretch emergency workers to their limits across an almost unimaginable swath of the Los Angeles area on Thursday.

The largest of the blazes, known as the Palisades Fire, swelled to more than 17,000 acres — an area bigger than the island of Manhattan — and devoured thousands of structures in its path. The ongoing catastrophe across Southern California has claimed at least five lives, though officials said they expect that toll to rise.

"It is safe to say that the SEE FIRES ON A5



A firefighter in Altadena, north of Los Angeles, on Thursday. The wildfires have caused tens of billions of dollars in damage and are on track to become the costliest fire disaster in U.S. history. Story, A5

Over two days, fire swallows L.A. neighborhoods

BY REIS THEBAULT AND JOSHUA PARTLOW

LOS ANGELES — Willemina Yospe set out on foot through a city on fire. She wore a white sweatshirt and carried an empty backpack. This was a rescue mission.

With the ocean behind her, flames up ahead and thick, yellowed smoke everywhere closing in, Yospe wound her way through one of the most sublime corners of the country, her heaven turned hell.

She was one of countless others scattered across the county, navigating wreckage as Los Angeles burned from three sides, the fires uniting a varied place in desperation.

Yospe didn't know if her home of 14 years, up a winding street in the Pacific Palisades on the city's SEE LOS ANGELES ON A6

IN THE NEWS

'DOGE' deregulation Federal rules have proliferated, but slashing them could be easier said than done, experts said. **A3**

'Grave concerns' Several former National Guard generals and others warned Congress against giving Maryland control of D.C.'s fighter jets. **B1**

THE NATION **Civil rights** icon Myrlie Evers-Williams's archive will go on display this summer. **A2** **A federal judge** struck down the White House's Title IX protections for transgender students. **A4**

THE WORLD **Lebanon's** parliament elected a president, opening the door to needed foreign aid. **A9** **Pentagon chief** Lloyd Austin called for continued Ukraine aid in Donald Trump's term. **A10**

THE ECONOMY **SpaceX rival** Blue Origin set a Sunday window for a pivotal test-launch of its New Glenn rocket, marking the company's first attempt to reach orbit. **A11** **Holiday shoppers** used "buy now, pay later" services more than ever in 2024. **A12**

THE REGION **The water system** in Richmond is fully operational after a winter storm disrupted service, but a boil advisory remains in place. **B1** **A former** Wootton High student who was found guilty of threatening to "shoot up" school faces up to 10 years. **B1**

STYLE **Hoda Kotb**, who is ending her 17-year run on NBC's "Today," energized the morning-show format. **C1** **WEEKEND** **The 13 worst** movies of 2024, a baker's dozen of cinematic dreck. We sat through them so you don't have to.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A11
COMICS.....C5
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A13
TELEVISION.....C4
WORLD NEWS.....A8

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0 170628 211001 3